The Advancement of America

By the turn of the 19th century, it is estimated that the population had grown to more than 7 million people. It reached more than 9 million in 1820 and then rose to 17,000,000 after 20 years. America was adding more states to expand its territory, the most notable state being Indiana, which was added in 1816.

The American economy began to develop quickly with the production of cotton in the southern states. On the other side of the Atlantic, Britain was experiencing a massive surge in the cotton industry and ended up purchasing vast amounts of the raw material from America. Over half of the cotton in the world was produced within USA by the mid-19th century. Furthermore, the coal mining industry became very popular during the early 19th century.

Infrastructure was being built to support the ever-growing population. Bridges, roads, homes and offices gained serious traction during this time. A canal was commissioned from the Hudson River all the way to Lake Erie in 1817 and was finally finished in 1825. This canal allowed a severe reduction in the costs of transporting goods from one location to another. After a few years, the country's first railways were built in New Jersey and Massachusetts.

In 1814, the natives from Florida and the Americans in Georgia began experiencing new problems. The natives were allowing slaves who had run away from their masters to hide amongst them, which the Americans did not like. The Seminole War began in 1821 when Andrew Jackson led American forces into Florida to fight the Spanish. In 1821, the Americans took Florida from Spain and it became a new American state.